

Coaches & Mentors Checklists

The best coaching groups are organised, consistent and positive.

These checklists are intended to help mentors stay prepared, reduce stress and create the best possible experience for players.

1. Mentor Compliance Checklist

Before the season begins, all mentors should ensure they are:

- Garda Vetted and in date
- Safeguarding certified and in date
- Registered on Foireann
- Paid-up club members
- Ratified by the Club Executive
- Familiar with club Child Protection procedures
- Aware of the Children's Officer and DLO contacts
- Using approved communication channels only

Recommended:

- ICGG / Foundation Coaching qualification
 - First Aid / CPR qualification
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2. Pre-Season Checklist

Team Planning

- Confirm player numbers and registrations
- Confirm emergency contact process
- Agree mentor role split
- Set up ClubZap communication
- Review competition rules and age regulations
- Review player pathway and skill focus for age group
- Plan training schedule and season structure

Parent Meeting

- Schedule annual parent meeting
- Explain team philosophy and expectations
- Discuss attendance and communication standards
- Explain grading/streaming where relevant
- Reinforce positive sideline behaviour
- Seek volunteer support where needed

Player Welfare & Permissions

- Confirm medical information/allergies
- Confirm emergency contact details
- Confirm photography/social media permissions
- Confirm ClubZap permissions and access
- Review safeguarding procedures with mentors
- Ensure all communication groups include parents/guardians

Equipment & Facilities

- Check footballs/sliotars
 - Check bibs, cones and pumps
 - Confirm first aid kit access
 - Confirm pitch access and lighting arrangements
 - Confirm jerseys and coaches bibs
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3. Start-of-Season Coaching Checklist

- Create a simple seasonal coaching plan
 - Agree key skills to focus on this term
 - Ensure sessions are age-appropriate
 - Plan a balance of fun, learning and games
 - Build player confidence early
 - Create an inclusive environment for all players
 - Reinforce effort, teamwork and respect
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4. Weekly Team Checklist

Weekly Organisation

- Confirm fixture details early in the week
- Confirm venue, referee and opposition
- Check weather and pitch updates where relevant
- Confirm player numbers and availability
- Send one clear communication message to parents
- Prepare equipment and emergency kit

Weekly Coaching

- What is tonight's objective?
- What are the key coaching points?
- What happens in the first 5 minutes?
- How will we maximise touches and minimise standing?
- What game-based activity is included?
- Is all equipment ready before players arrive?
- Run a purposeful session linked to the week's objective

During Training

- Keep players active and engaged
- Demonstrate clearly and briefly
- Use questioning and encouragement
- Praise effort and decision making
- Adapt activities if needed
- Ensure all players are included

End of Session

- Finish positively and with energy - Reinforce one or two key learnings
 - Check for injuries/issues
 - Follow up on incidents or unresolved concerns
 - Review what worked well
 - Confirm next session/match details
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5. Match Day Checklist

Before the Match

- Confirm fixture, venue and throw-in time
- Confirm referee arrangements and payment process
- Contact opposition/referee if required
- Arrive in time to set up, not merely to start
- Check goals, playing area and player equipment
- Bring:
 - First aid kit
 - Ice packs
 - Bibs
 - Match balls
 - Match jerseys

Player Preparation

- Check players have:
 - Mouthguards
 - Helmets where applicable
 - Water bottles
 - Correct kit

During the Match

- Keep sideline calm and positive
- Respect referees and opponents
- Rotate players fairly where appropriate
- Focus on development and enjoyment
- Encourage decision making and bravery on the ball
- Communicate calmly and positively throughout

After the Match

- Thank referee, opposition and volunteers
 - Return equipment and tidy pitch area
 - Return results if required
 - Log injuries or concerns promptly
 - Follow up on injuries/issues
 - Highlight positives with players
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6. Player Welfare & Safeguarding Checklist

- Use group communication only
 - No one-to-one messaging with players
 - Know medical concerns/allergies
 - Maintain appropriate supervision ratios
 - Follow concussion guidance
 - "If in doubt, sit them out"
 - Escalate welfare concerns appropriately
 - Create a safe, respectful environment at all times
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7. Equipment & Facilities Checklist

- Goals secured safely
 - Equipment stored correctly after use
 - Dressing rooms and facilities respected
 - Lights switched off after sessions
 - Training area left clean and safe
 - Report damaged equipment promptly
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8. Term / Mid-Season Review Checklist

- Are players improving and enjoying training?
 - Are sessions matching the age group needs?
 - Are all players getting opportunities?
 - Does streaming/grading need review?
 - Are mentors communicating well together?
 - Are parents informed and engaged?
 - Are player pathway challenges completed?
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9. End-of-Season Checklist

- Review player development and progress
- Return jerseys and equipment
- Thank volunteers and parents
- Identify mentor training needs
- Review what worked well this season
- Begin planning for next year